

The Culture of Business, Finance and the Economy

Class 18 – 21 may

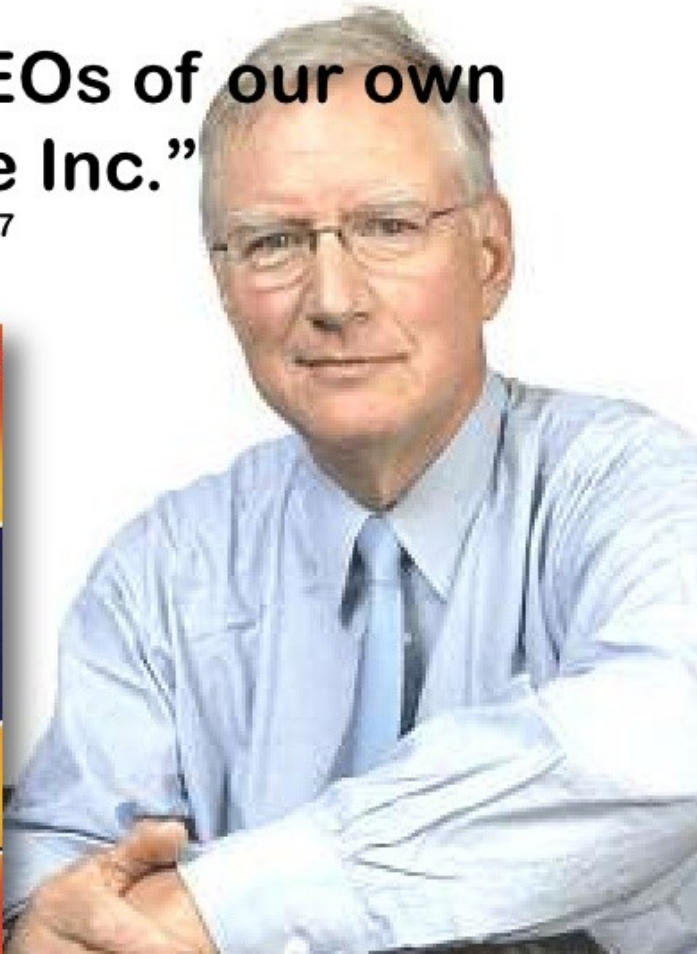
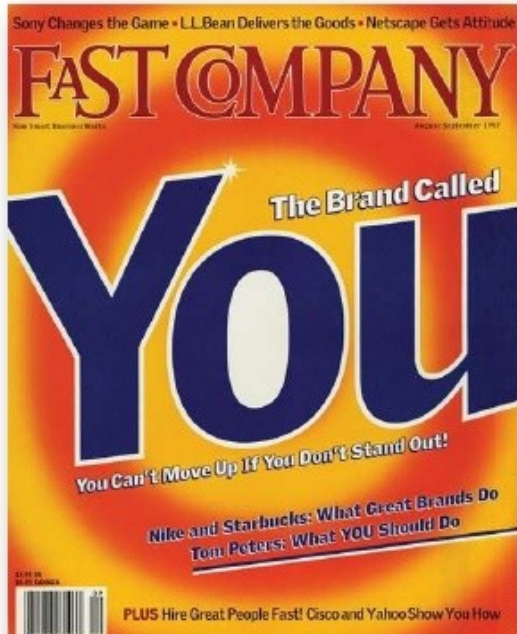
Dr. Juan M. del Nido
First semester 2026

Recap

The Entrepreneurial Self as a business

“We are the CEOs of our own companies: Me Inc.”

- Tom Peters, **Fast Company** 1997



Down and Out



in the



New Economy



How People Find
(or Don't Find)
Work Today



Ilana Gershon

Today

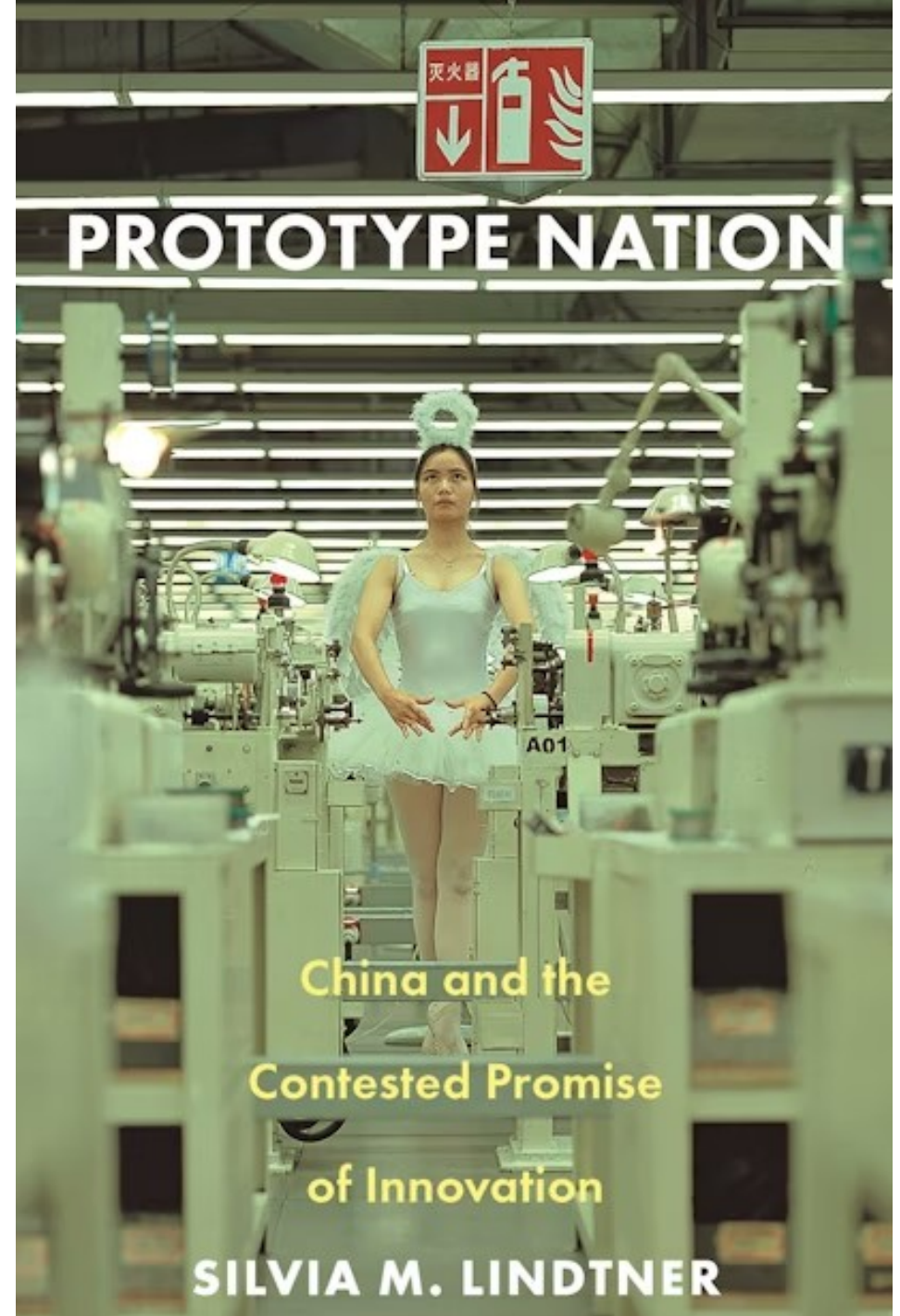
From makerspaces to venture capitalism I: the way of the start-up



What is a startup incubator program



An ethnography of prototyping and start-ups since the 2000s



Hackerspaces, makerspaces, hackatons (early 2000s)



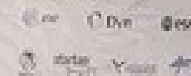
Welcome to TechCrunch

#hackath_n

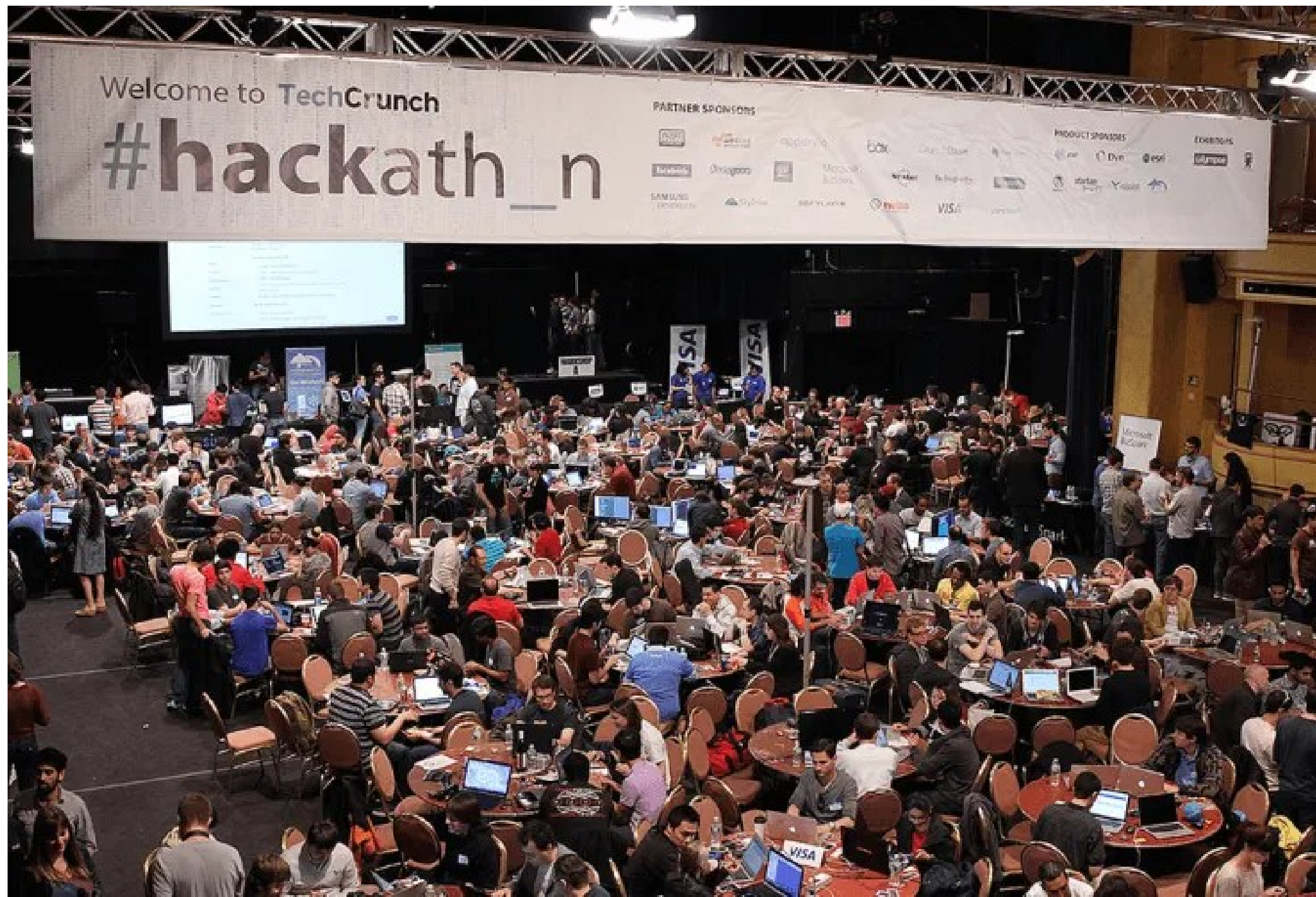
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PRODUCT SPONSORS



EXHIBITORS



**playful experimentation, fun and
flexible, peer production, community.
Chaotic, unscripted, unruly.**

**from being a consumer to being a
maker, a producer, someone who can
make stuff, whether tote bags or
software**

Playing for playing's sake

‘Since around 2011, a recurring topic in the hacker and (maker) spaces where I had been embedded since 2008 was how to “take things to the next level” and to “scale up.”’

Incubators



[Home](#) / [Topics](#) / [What Is A Startup Incubator Program](#)

What Is A Startup Incubator Program

This page is a digest about this topic. It is a compilation from various blogs that discuss it. Each title is linked to the original blog.

[+](#) Free Help and discounts from **FasterCapital!**

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The topic *what is a startup incubator program* has 98 sections. Narrow your search by using keyword search and selecting one of the keywords below:

[incubator programs \(24\)](#)[networking opportunities \(20\)](#)[ultimate faq \(15\)](#)[industry experts \(12\)](#)[office space \(11\)](#)[funding opportunities \(10\)](#)[track record \(10\)](#)[potential investors \(9\)](#)[application process \(9\)](#)[business plan \(9\)](#)[startup incubators \(9\)](#)

Here

“A startup incubator program is a **structured and **intensive** initiative designed to **support** and **nurture** early-stage startup companies. These programs provide entrepreneurs with a range of resources, guidance, and mentorship to help them **grow their businesses** and **increase their chances of success.**”**

You play to WIN.

What is a startup incubator program



1. Application process: Incubator programs typically have a competitive application process, where startups are selected based on their potential for growth and innovation. Only the most promising and viable startups are accepted.

2. Physical workspace: Most incubator programs provide startups with a dedicated physical workspace, often in the form of shared office space or a co-working environment. This not only gives startups a professional setting to work in but also **fosters collaboration and networking with other entrepreneurs.**

3. Access to resources: Incubator programs offer startups access to resources such as office equipment, meeting rooms, internet connectivity, and other infrastructure necessary for running a business.

4. Mentoring and guidance: One of the most valuable aspects is the **mentorship and guidance provided to startups**. Experienced entrepreneurs, industry experts, and investors (offer) their expertise and insights to help them navigate challenges and **make informed decisions**.

5. Networking opportunities: the opportunity to connect with a diverse network of entrepreneurs, investors, and industry professionals. These connections can lead to potential partnerships, collaborations, and funding opportunities, which are crucial for the growth of a startup.

6. Workshops and educational programs: Incubator programs often organize **workshops, seminars, and educational programs** to help startups develop their skills and knowledge in key areas such as business strategy, marketing, finance, and operations.

7. funding and investment opportunities: Many incubator programs have **partnerships with venture capitalists, angel investors**, and other funding sources. This opens up opportunities for startups to secure funding and investment, which is often critical in the early stages of a business.

8. Peer support and collaboration: Being part of an incubator program provides startups with **a supportive and collaborative community of like-minded entrepreneurs**. This peer support can be invaluable for sharing experiences, learning from each other's successes and failures, and building lasting relationships within the startup ecosystem.

9. Time-limited program: Incubator programs usually have a set duration, typically ranging from a few months to a couple of years. This time-limited structure provides startups with a focused and intensive environment to accelerate their growth and progress towards a more mature stage.

Create a strong application for the startup incubator program:

Executive Summary: This document should clearly explain why your business idea is unique and why it has the potential to be successful. **Additionally, it should showcase your experience and qualifications as an entrepreneur.**

Business Plan: Your business plan should outline the goals of your business, how you plan to achieve these goals, and how you will finance the venture. Additionally, it should include a detailed financial projection that outlines projected revenues, expenses, and profits over the next five years.

Highlight Your Team: Incubator programs are looking for teams that have the right combination of skills and experience. Provide detailed information about each member of your team and highlight the unique strengths they bring to the table.

Showcase Your Achievements: Demonstrating your track record of success will help boost the credibility of your application. Provide evidence of any previous business ventures you've been involved with and discuss any awards or recognition you've received for your work.

Provide References: Make sure you have at least three people who can vouch for your qualifications and provide thoughtful insights on why you would be a great fit for the program.

Be Professional: All parts of your application should be professional, from the design of your executive summary to the formatting of your business plan. It's important to make sure all documents are free of typos and grammatical errors, as this can make or break your chances of being accepted into an incubator program.

Reach Out to Program Mentors: Making connections with these mentors can be extremely beneficial when applying for an incubator program, so make sure you reach out and introduce yourself prior to submitting your application.

**Incubators are
“start-up
schools” that
“coin
entrepreneurs
first and ideas
later.”**

‘The business book to read right now’
GQ.com

MAKERS

**The New Industrial
Revolution**

Bestselling author of *The Long Tail*

CHRIS ANDERSON



MAKING WAVES.

SHARK TANK



incubators appeared to retain the commitment to playful experimentation, fun and flexible work culture, peer production, and community that many had come to identify with maker and hacker culture. The same enthusiasm, the same “having fun”, but the promise is to connect this culture of tinkering to “the real world.” Crucial to making the “switch” into entrepreneurship: learning how to **derive pleasure not only from hacking machines but from hacking markets**

Who carries this kind of promise?

3H PERSONALITY THEORY

HUSTLER, HACKER, AND HIPSTER FOR FOUNDING STARTUPS



[Link here](#)

success of a large-scale global sample of startups ($n = 21,187$). We find that the Big Five personality traits of startup founders across 30 dimensions significantly differ from that of the population at large. Key personality facets that distinguish successful entrepreneurs include a preference for variety, novelty and starting new things (openness to adventure), like being the centre of attention (lower levels of modesty) and being exuberant (higher activity levels). We do not find one 'Founder-type' personality; instead, six different personality types appear. Our results also demonstrate the benefits of larger, personality-diverse teams in startups, which show an increased likelihood of success. The findings emphasise the role of the diversity of personality types as a novel dimension of team diversity that influences performance and success.

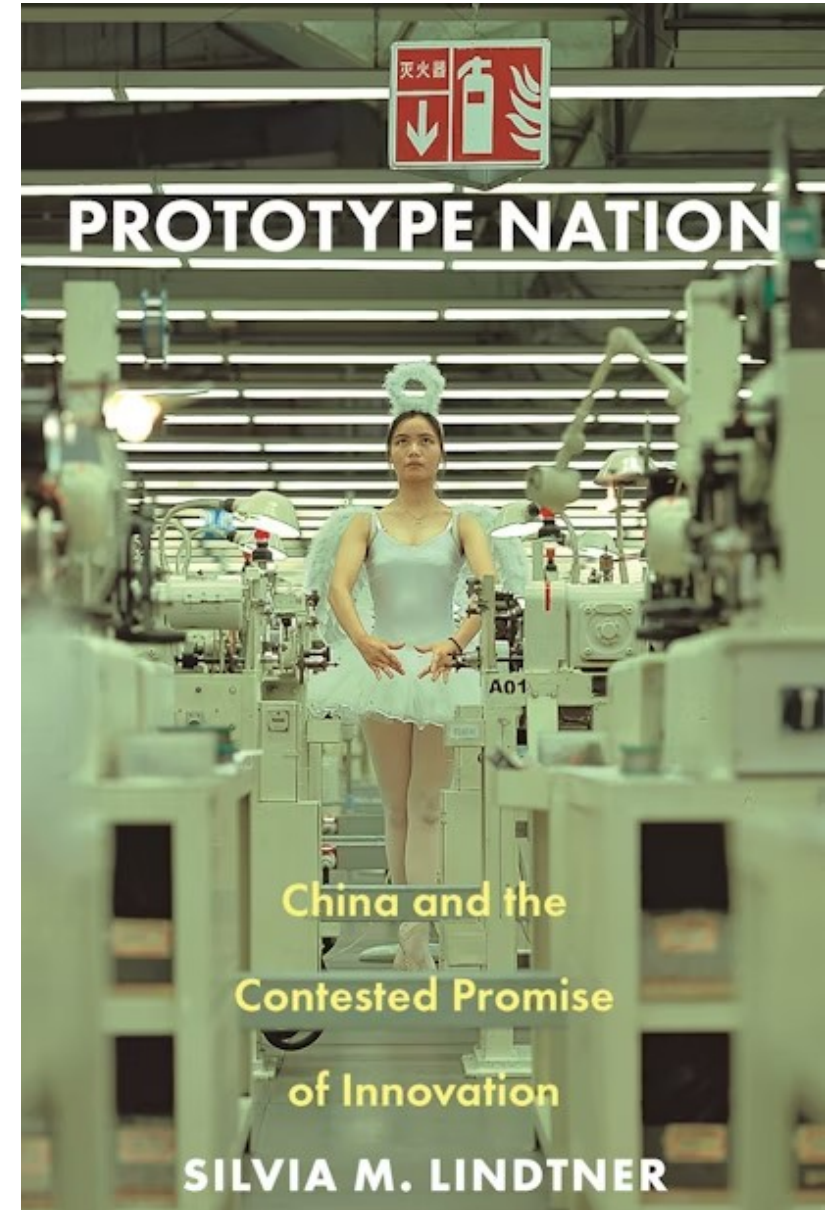
**The start up “kind”, background, skills and
career trajectory**

**Compare with
Consultants
Financial Analysts**

Break

Lindtner's Prototype Nation: Shenzhen

**3 months in an
incubator in
Shenzhen, the
prototyping capital
of China**



Hardware acceleration program

The UCHINA acceleration program empowers startups to create a working prototype of their product concept in the shortest time possible. Our one-stop service will move the product from concept to mass production with minimal hassles and delays.



UCHINA is based in Shenzhen, the hardware paradise. Our office is in Troublemaker, a makerspace located in Huaqiangbei, the world's largest electronics market. This strategic location allows us to quickly get hold of parts and components needed to create product prototypes.

Something that takes years in other countries can be produced in a few months in Shenzhen, if you know how. Tap on our vast experience and network to accelerate your product.



On the second day of the program, Peter O'Melly, the CEO of the Western venture capital firm that had funded the Shenzhen incubator, gave a speech that reminded me of the kind of motivational, often deliberately personal talks that have become notorious in tech and through things like TED. O'Melly was giving his famous "rocket-fuel speech"

The speech, meant to motivate the start-up teams for the weeks to come, also modelled the entrepreneur: confident, survivalist, optimist, interventionist:

I am here to talk about the meaning of life. (...) As entrepreneurs, we are high up at the chain of life, because we self-actualize. We live in a very unique time of this planet, where makers have the opportunity to affect billions of people. Charles Darwin once said, "it is not the strongest of the species that survives nor the most intelligent, but the most responsive to change." We live in an environment of change. People who do this best are those who listen to their customers, mentors and to themselves and make that change. Through entrepreneurship, we have disproportionate power to affect the world.

[Link here](#)



Ideas change everything

WATCH

DISCOVER

ATTEND

Discover › Topics

Entrepreneur

A collection of TED Talks (and more) on the topic of Entrepreneur.

Why start ups in Shenzhen, of all places?

UCHINA is based in Shenzhen, the hardware paradise. Our office is in Troublemaker, a makerspace located in Huaqiangbei, the world's largest electronics market. This strategic location allows us to quickly get hold of parts and components needed to create product prototypes.

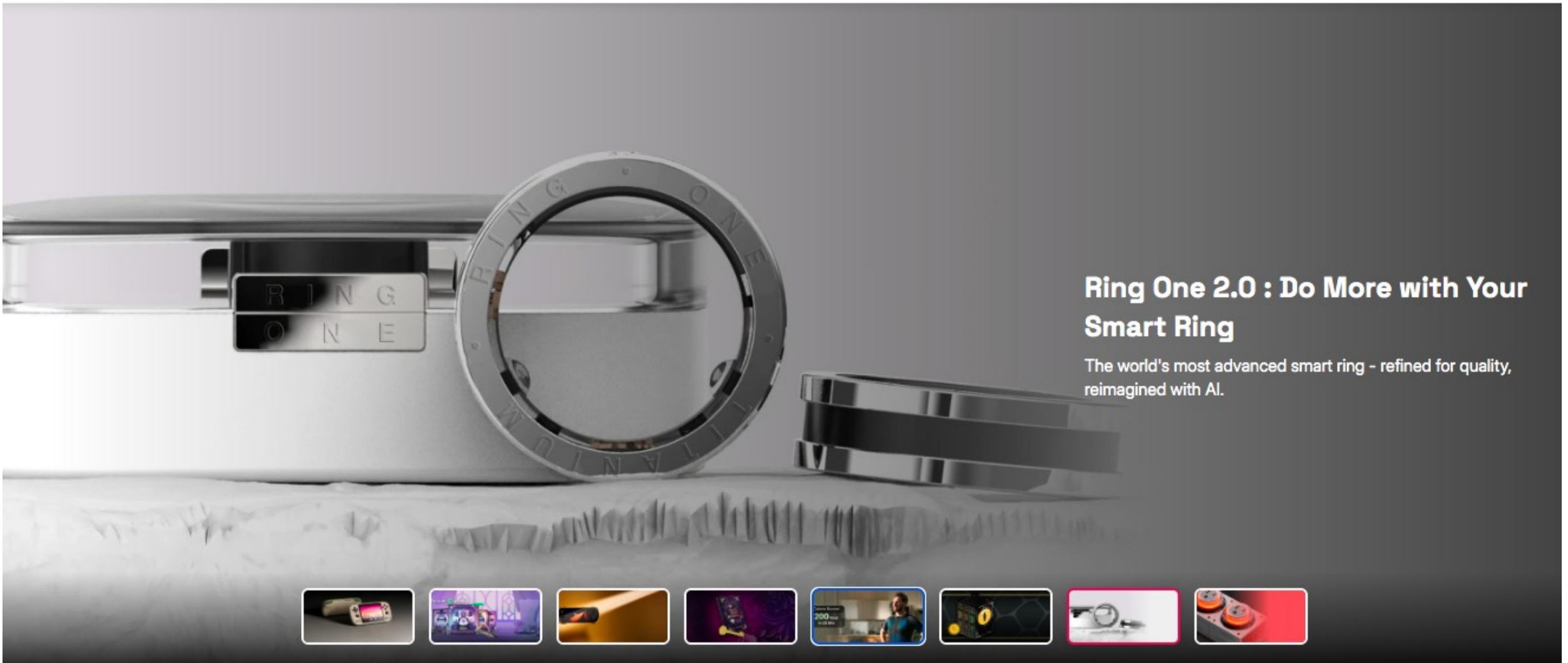
Something that takes years in other countries can be produced in a few months in Shenzhen, if you know how. Tap on our vast experience and network to accelerate your product.



Why Shenzhen?

By “accelerating” the time it takes to bring a new product to market, one increases one’s attractiveness to investors. The start-up can only compete with traditional “economies of scale” by stepping outside their dependency on product sales and attracting finance capital. Shenzhen was enriched with this sense of speed—it promised to teach people how to accelerate.

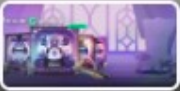
The program trained the teams to attract the interests of two sets of audiences: capital investors and a potential consumer base. The former with pitches (next class); the latter via crowdfunding platforms.



The main image shows a sleek, silver smart ring with a circular display and a small rectangular screen. The words "RING ONE" are visible on the rectangular screen. The ring is resting on a reflective surface, and its reflection is visible below it. To the right of the ring, there is a stack of three black rings.

Ring One 2.0 : Do More with Your Smart Ring

The world's most advanced smart ring - refined for quality, reimagined with AI.



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Bring a creative project to life.

FEATURED PROJECT



Return to Dark Tower: Expeditions

Restoration Games

⌚ 6 days left • 298% funded

Conquer the Dark Tower with new heroes, gear, treasures, and more in this all new 3rd printed expansion pack.

RECOMMENDED FOR YOU



Hyper TrackPad Pro

Hyper Products Inc.

⌚ 31 days left • 2432% funded



A Design-Forward Carrom Board That...

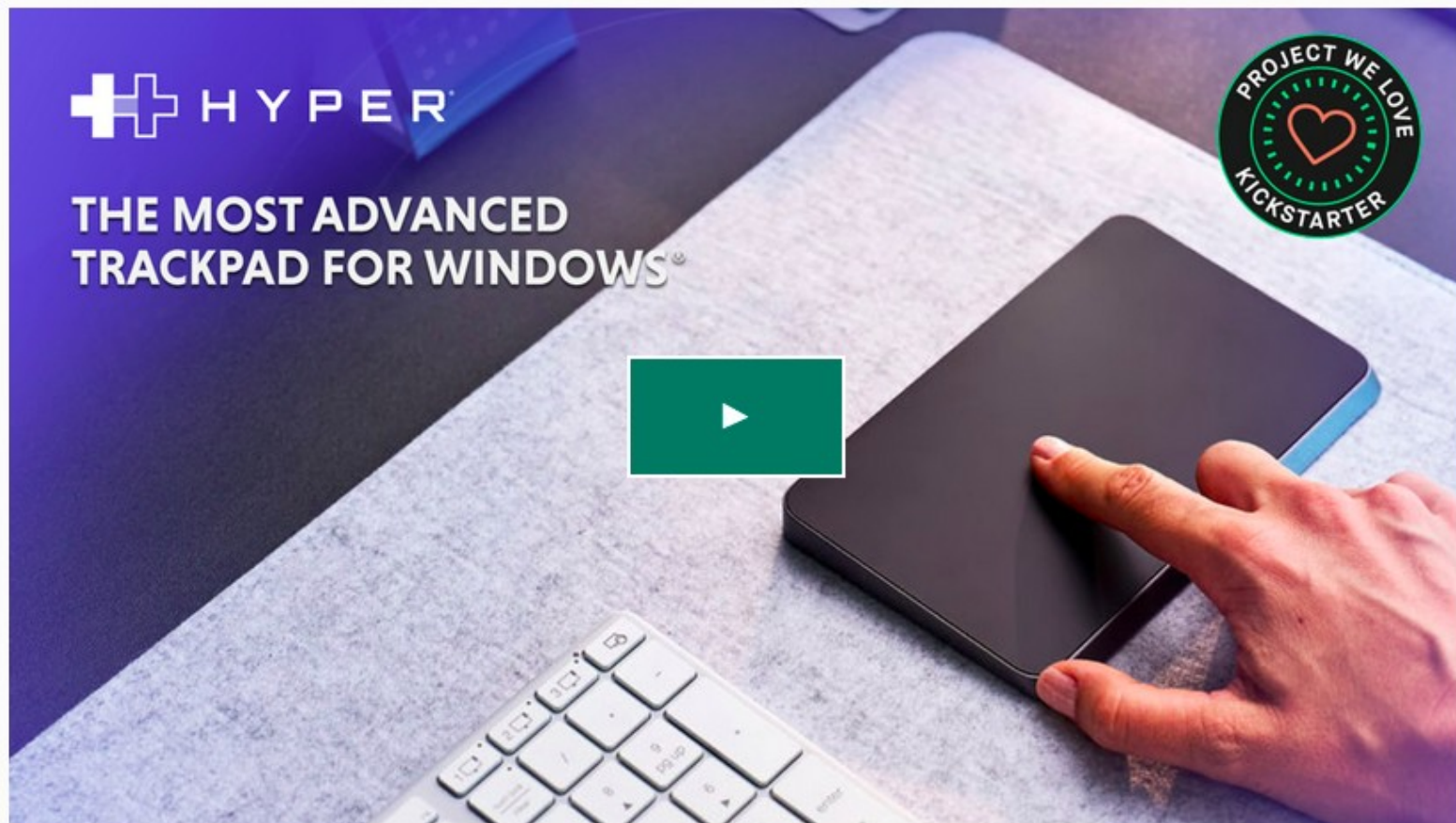
Faraz Warsi

⌚ 1 day left • 424% funded



Hyper TrackPad Pro

The world's most advanced Windows® trackpad. HyperSpace Trackpad Pro delivers precision, contextual haptics, and full-force sensing.



US\$ 121,619

pledged of US\$ 5,000 goal

1,081

backers

31

days to go

Back this project

Remind me



All or nothing. This project will only be funded if it reaches its goal by Sat, November 22 2025 2:59 AM UTC -03:00.



Project We Love



Hardware



Los Angeles, CA

The crowdfunding campaigns were not actually designed to sell products or to actually raise money. Most hardware start-ups barely break even or even lose money from the sales made through their crowdfunding campaigns.

Why do them, then?

They show the product had a potential market. Investors look for these indicators to minimize their risks in investing. A successful campaign shows the promise of future gains, of enhancements to investors' portfolios, of contributions to the next share sale. The start-ups were taught to produce not products to be sold, but promises to be invested in.

Conclusion

**Incubators and
accelerators: speed, scale
and magnitude towards
venture capitals**